

EYEWITNESS April 9, 1865

Surrender at Appomattox

After General Robert E. Lee's Army of Northern Virginia made a final stand at Appomattox Court House, he found his Confederate army to be both surrounded and exhausted. Lee exchanged a series of letters with General Ulysses S. Grant on April 9, 1865. Later that afternoon, the two men met to draw up the formal terms of surrender.

"At a little before 4 o'clock General Lee shook hands with General Grant, bowed to the other officers, and with Colonel Marshall left the room. One after another we followed, and passed out to the porch. Lee signaled to his orderly to bring up his horse, and while the animal was being bridled the general stood on the lowest step and gazed sadly in the direction of the valley beyond where his army lay—now an army of prisoners. He smote his hands together a number of times in an absent sort of a way; seemed not to see the group of Union officers in the yard who rose respectfully at his approach, and appeared unconscious of everything about him. All appreciated the sadness that overwhelmed him, and he had the personal sympathy of every one who beheld him at this supreme moment of trial. The approach of his horse seemed to recall him from his reverie, and he at once mounted. General Grant now stepped down from the porch, and, moving toward him, saluted him by raising his hat. He was followed in this act of courtesy by all our officers present; Lee raised his hat respectfully, and rode off to break the sad news to the brave fellows who he had so long commanded ..."

GENERAL HORACE PORTER, WHO SERVED ON GRANT'S STAFF, FROM AN ARTICLE IN *THE CENTURY* MAGAZINE, NOVEMBER 1887

"For us they were fellow soldiers as well, suffering the fate of arms. We could not look into those brave, bronzed faces, and those battered flags we had met on so many fields where glorious manhood lent a glory to the earth that bore it, and think of personal hate and mean revenge. Whoever had misled these men, we had not. We had led them back, home. Whoever had made that quarrel,